



Why your skin changed after 40, and what a doctor *looks at first*

A plain-English guide for women who look in the mirror and think: "Something has changed. I don't want to look done. I just want to look like myself again."

Dr Maria Mackey

MBChB FRACGP FAARM · Mojo Cosmetic Clinic and Mojo Klinik, Neutral Bay



PART ONE

"When did my skin *start doing this?*"

Most women don't notice one big change. They notice lots of small ones, and then one day the mirror catches them off guard. If you're nodding along to a few of these, you're in good company.

- ✓ Your skin looks thinner, drier or a little crepey, especially around the eyes and neck
- ✓ It looks dull or tired, even after a good night's sleep
- ✓ Fine lines, uneven tone or old sun damage seem to have appeared from nowhere
- ✓ Products that used to work don't seem to do much anymore
- ✓ You see hollows under your eyes, or your jawline feels softer than it did
- ✓ Your face feels tight, puffy or tense, like you're carrying stress in it
- ✓ The changes lined up with other changes: your cycle, your sleep, your energy

"The most common thing patients say at their first cosmetic consultation is that they do not want to look done. They want to look like the version of themselves they recognise."

Dr Maria Mackey

Here's the reassuring part: none of this means your skin has stopped working. It usually means something underneath has shifted. Understanding *what* is the first step.

PART TWO

Skin *from within*

At Mojo, one idea runs through everything: **skin from within**. How your skin looks is influenced by what is happening inside your body. So before any treatment is talked about, Dr Maria looks at the bigger picture.

Hormones

Perimenopause and menopause speed up collagen loss and skin thinning. Hormones also play a part in skin texture, pore size and some patterns of acne.

Nutrition

Your nutritional status affects how well skin repairs itself. Where it's relevant, it can be assessed and addressed.

Gut health

The gut and skin are connected. Hormonal acne and the gut-skin connection are areas Dr Maria works in regularly.

Inflammation

Ongoing inflammation can drive skin conditions such as rosacea, acne and eczema.

Perimenopause isn't a single event. Dr Maria describes it as a biological process that can run for 10 to 15 years, with symptoms that can begin in the late thirties. That's why so many women in their forties feel their skin changed "suddenly".

"If there is a hormonal driver, a nutrient deficiency, or a gut issue presenting on your face, treating only the surface gives you only surface results. The face follows the biology underneath."

Dr Maria Mackey

PART THREE

What "regenerative care" *actually means*

You'll see the word "regenerative" everywhere. At Mojo it has a simple meaning: care that starts with your skin's biology and works with your body's own repair processes, with procedures chosen selectively for you rather than from a set menu.

Two ways to come in. You choose.

A

Cosmetic on its own

A consultation focused entirely on your skin and the treatments offered. No integrative discussion needed.

B

Cosmetic plus integrative

A cosmetic plan alongside an integrative consultation looking at the hormonal, nutritional, gut or metabolic factors affecting your skin.

Neither requires the other. Some women know hormones or insulin resistance are part of their skin picture and want to look at it. Others just want to focus on their skin. Both are valid.

Every treatment, including the gentlest, has possible risks and side effects. These, along with alternatives and aftercare, are explained at your consultation before you decide anything.

PART FOUR

Options she may *discuss*

These are some of the treatments offered at Mojo. Which, if any, suit you is worked out together at your consultation.

Led by Mojo's skin therapist, under clinical oversight

Treatment	What it involves
Skin needling	Fine sterile needles create controlled micro-injuries to prompt collagen and elastin over a series of treatments. Usually a course of 3 sessions, 4 to 6 weeks apart, then maintenance.
SQT Bio-Microneedling	Biological micro-needles from freshwater sponge spicules. No devices, electricity or metal needles. Often chosen for sensitive skin.
Clinical peels	Controlled acid formulations remove damaged outer layers. Depth and formulation are matched to your skin.
Buccal Sculpt and Release	A facial massage that works from inside and outside the cheeks to release tension held in the face.
Onda	Non-invasive microwave-based technology for body contouring and facial skin tightening.

Performed personally by Dr Maria

Procedure	What it involves
PRP (platelet-rich plasma)	A small sample of your own blood is processed and the platelet-rich plasma is delivered to the skin. More on this over the page.
Aptos threads	Absorbable threads placed in the deeper layers of the skin. Dr Maria trained in Aptos at advanced level in Tbilisi, Georgia.

PRP and thread procedures are classed by AHPRA as higher-risk non-surgical cosmetic procedures. They need a clinical consultation, individual prescription and written consent before treatment.

PART FIVE

Not all PRP is *prepared the same way*

If you've been researching PRP, you've probably seen three terms. They describe genuinely different preparations. Here is the difference in plain words.

	Emcyte PurePRP (used at Mojo)	Standard PRP	PRF
Prepared in	An FDA-cleared closed-system device with sealed kits	Generic glass or plastic tubes	Specific glass tubes
Spin	Double spin in a sealed kit	Single spin in an open tube	Slow single spin
Platelet concentration	High, compared with whole blood	Lower, and varies by tube and operator	Lower than spun PRP, held in a fibrin matrix
Consistency	More consistent between sessions	More variable between samples	Varies with tube and timing
In Australia	All three are classed by AHPRA as higher-risk non-surgical cosmetic procedures.		

The choice of preparation is a clinical decision. It depends on what is being treated, the area and your individual circumstances, and it is made with you at your consultation.

Good to know

Possible risks of PRP include bruising, swelling, infection and blood-draw reactions such as fainting. Changes, if any, develop gradually and may need more than one session. Dr Maria explains suitability, alternatives, side effects and aftercare in detail before any treatment.

PART SIX

What to look for, and *what to ask*

Whichever clinic you choose, these questions help you tell the difference between a treatment menu and real care.

Look for a clinic that

- ✓ Has a doctor assess you face to face before any medical procedure
- ✓ Asks about your health, hormones and history, not only your face
- ✓ Takes baseline photos for your file
- ✓ Explains risks and alternatives before prices
- ✓ Is happy for you to go away and think about it
- ✓ Never prescribes injectables by text, email or online form

Questions to ask

- ✓ What do you think is driving the change in my skin?
- ✓ Who will actually do my treatment?
- ✓ How many sessions, how far apart, and what happens after?
- ✓ What are the risks and the downtime for me?
- ✓ What are my alternatives, including doing nothing?
- ✓ For PRP: how is it prepared here, and why?

MEET YOUR DOCTOR

Dr Maria Mackey



Dr Maria Mackey is the founder of Mojo Klinik and Mojo Cosmetic Clinic in Neutral Bay. She graduated in medicine in 1993 and is a Fellow of the Royal Australian College of General Practitioners. Her practice centres on integrative and functional medicine, with a special interest in women's hormonal health, perimenopause and menopause, gut health and regenerative cosmetic medicine.

She brings the same thinking to your skin that she brings to everything else: understand the mechanism first, then build a plan with a clear reason for every recommendation.

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YOUR NEXT STEP

Start with a *conversation*

At a cosmetic consultation, Dr Maria reviews your skin and relevant health history, takes baseline clinical photos, and explains what she sees and what she would suggest. You leave with a clear picture and no obligation.

Skin likes a rhythm

Many skin treatments are done as a short course with time in between. If a course suits you, booking it up front keeps you on track and costs less than paying session by session. Ask about courses of three at your consultation.

Book

Call **02 9133 8500** or book online at mojocosmeticclinic.com.au
Suite 11, Ground Floor, 40 Yeo St, Neutral Bay NSW 2089

This guide is general information only. It is not medical advice, a diagnosis or a recommendation for any specific treatment. All procedures carry risks. Individual results vary. Treatment is only offered after a face-to-face consultation, to people 18 and over.